



FLAGSHIP CASE STUDY 04

Project Delivery Recovery & Scrum Operating System

A generalized recovery system for stabilizing a stalled cross-functional initiative and restoring evidence-based delivery.

AUTHOR	CASE TYPE	FOCUS
Nina Suico, CSM	Portfolio simulation	Project Delivery Scrum PMO Business Analysis

The project is busy. The outcome is still uncertain.

SCENARIO

A multi-team implementation is twelve weeks into delivery. Stakeholders report constant activity, but scope changes are entering through several channels, backlog items lack acceptance criteria, dependencies age without owners, and sprint commitments are repeatedly missed.

MANDATE

Stabilize the initiative without pausing all delivery. Establish a common outcome, decision rights, a recovery backlog, visible risk controls, and a sustainable operating cadence.

BUSINESS QUESTION

What must change in the next two weeks so that leadership can distinguish genuine progress from motion?

THE SYSTEM MUST ANSWER

Outcome clarity

What business result defines success, and what is outside the recovery scope.

Backlog readiness

Which work is sufficiently defined, valuable, testable, and dependency-aware.

Flow health

Where work waits, blocks, expands, or returns for rework.

Decision speed

Which unresolved choices are stopping delivery and who owns them.

Recovery confidence

Whether delivery evidence supports the next forecast and release decision.

Evidence note. The method is informed by Nina Suico's Certified ScrumMaster training and documented work in Product Owner support, requirements gathering, workflow design, UAT coordination, system rollout, automation, reporting, and cross-functional handoffs. The scenario, metrics, and recovery outcomes are synthetic.

Make work, decisions, and outcomes traceable

The delivery model connects business intent to executable work, validation evidence, dependencies, risks, and release decisions.

OUTCOME Target state, value, success measure, sponsor	EPIC Capability, scope boundary, owner, priority	STORY User value, acceptance criteria, estimate, status
DEPENDENCY Provider, consumer, due date, impact, owner	RISK / ISSUE Cause, exposure, response, trigger, owner	DECISION Question, options, authority, due date, rationale

Decision architecture

Management question	Required evidence	Decision enabled
Are we building the right outcome?	Outcome statement, success measure, scope boundary, and sponsor agreement.	Continue, reframe, narrow, or stop work.
Is work ready to enter delivery?	Value, acceptance criteria, dependencies, estimate, and accountable owner.	Commit, refine, split, or return to discovery.
Why is flow slowing down?	Cycle time, blocked time, WIP age, rework, and dependency status.	Remove constraint, reduce WIP, escalate, or resequence.
Can the release be trusted?	Accepted work, defect status, test evidence, unresolved risk, and operational readiness.	Release, conditionally release, defer, or rollback.

Find the constraints before rewriting the plan

Synthetic baseline captured across the backlog, active work, dependencies, risks, and decision queue.

BACKLOG READY**41%**

26 of 64 items meet readiness

AGED WIP**38%**

Work beyond expected flow window

OPEN DEPENDENCIES**27**

Nine already past due

AGED DECISIONS**14**

Unresolved for more than five days

SPRINT PREDICTABILITY**58%**

Completed vs committed points

Constraint map

Observed symptom	Likely operating cause	Recovery control
Commitments repeatedly missed	Unready work enters sprint planning and hidden dependencies surface after commitment.	Definition of Ready, dependency check, capacity-based commitment.
Work starts but does not finish	WIP exceeds team capacity and blockers have no escalation threshold.	WIP limits, blocker owner, aging trigger, daily exception review.
Acceptance arrives late	Business and test expectations are clarified after build work begins.	Acceptance criteria and validation approach agreed before commitment.
Leadership receives conflicting status	Teams report activity, completion, and confidence using different definitions.	One outcome view, one RAID log, and evidence-based status rules.

Replace percentage-complete reporting with delivery evidence

Synthetic four-sprint history. The recovery forecast uses completed work, flow time, blocker exposure, and backlog readiness.

Sprint	Committed	Completed	Predictability	Median cycle	Blocked time	Escaped defects
Sprint 1	42 pts	23 pts	55%	12.8 days	4.7 days	7
Sprint 2	40 pts	25 pts	63%	11.9 days	4.2 days	6
Sprint 3	44 pts	24 pts	55%	12.1 days	4.0 days	5
Sprint 4	38 pts	24 pts	63%	10.4 days	3.5 days	4

96	24	18-27	3
Points completed across four sprints	Median throughput per sprint	Evidence-based next-sprint range	Critical dependencies before release

Forecast guardrails

Forecast condition	Management interpretation	Action
Backlog readiness below 70%	The team cannot responsibly fill the next commitment window.	Shift capacity to refinement and dependency resolution.
Critical dependency lacks dated owner action	Release confidence is unsupported regardless of activity volume.	Escalate, resequence, or remove dependent scope.
Cycle time exceeds service threshold	Work is aging faster than it is completing.	Reduce WIP and swarm the oldest viable item.

Remove constraints before adding more scope

Synthetic recovery items are sequenced by urgency, value, risk reduction, effort, and their effect on downstream delivery.

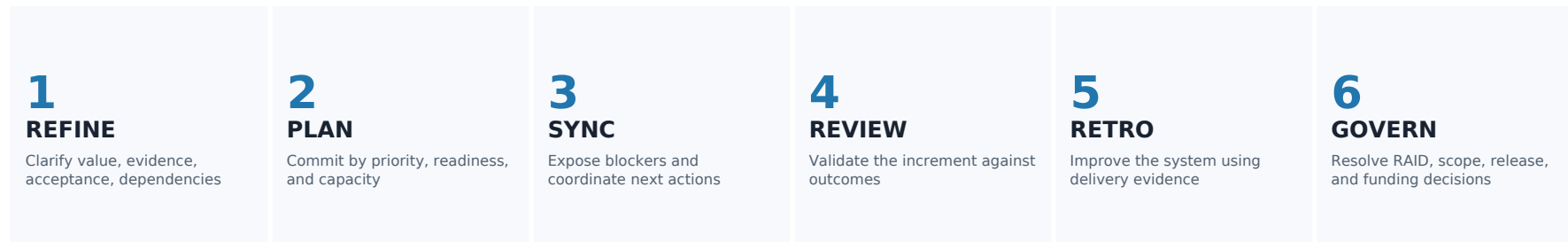
Recovery item	Value	Urgency	Risk reduction	Effort	Priority	Decision
Resolve identity-provider dependency	10	10	9	3	9.7	Do now
Agree release acceptance criteria	9	9	9	3	9.0	Do now
Split onboarding workflow epic	8	8	7	3	7.7	Next
Clean duplicate backlog items	6	7	5	2	9.0	Delegate
Automate weekly status pack	5	4	3	5	2.4	Later

Recovery lanes

Recovery lane	Entry rule	Exit condition
NOW	Critical constraint or decision directly blocks committed delivery.	Owner action completed and downstream work can proceed.
NEXT	High-value work is ready after current constraints are removed.	Acceptance criteria, dependencies, estimate, and owner confirmed.
LATER	Useful improvement does not change immediate recovery confidence.	Capacity exists without displacing higher-value recovery work.

Use cadence to accelerate decisions, not manufacture ceremony

The operating model combines Scrum events with delivery governance so that planning, risk, validation, and stakeholder decisions remain connected.



Management cadence

Cadence	Core decision	Minimum evidence	Accountable owner
Daily flow review	What must move, stop, or escalate today?	Aging WIP, blockers, dependencies, owner action.	Delivery lead
Sprint planning	What can be responsibly committed?	Priority, readiness, capacity, dependency status.	Product owner + team
Sprint review	What outcome evidence was created?	Accepted increment, feedback, defects, changed assumptions.	Product owner
Weekly recovery forum	Which cross-team decisions need authority?	RAID exceptions, decision queue, release confidence.	Sponsor + delivery lead
Retrospective	What operating constraint should change next?	Flow trends, failure demand, team observations, action owner.	Scrum Master

Stabilize first. Improve predictability second.

The sequence restores decision quality and work readiness before expanding automation, reporting, or delivery scope.

DAYS 1-10	STABILIZE	Confirm outcome, freeze unmanaged intake, map stakeholders, baseline flow, and establish one RAID log.	Output: recovery charter, baseline, immediate decision queue.
DAYS 11-30	CONTROL	Clean backlog, define readiness and done, assign dependencies, set WIP and escalation rules.	Output: recovery backlog, ownership model, delivery controls.
DAYS 31-60	DELIVER	Run controlled sprints, validate increments early, review flow weekly, and recalibrate commitments.	Output: accepted increments, evidence-based forecast, lessons.
DAYS 61-90	SUSTAIN	Embed governance, automate only stable reporting, coach owners, and transition recovery controls into normal delivery.	Output: operating cadence, dashboard requirements, handover.

WHAT A HIRING MANAGER CAN INFER	ROLE ALIGNMENT
Nina can translate a stalled initiative into a structured recovery system, connect outcomes to executable work, expose delivery constraints, coordinate decisions and validation, and establish a practical Scrum and governance cadence.	Project Manager Implementation Manager PMO Analyst Scrum Master Business Operations

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